

Why Do Leaves Change Color?: answers

Grade 3 · 11 points. Accept any sensible answer that is backed up by the text.

1. A pigment called chlorophyll. (1 point)

Finding information (RI.3.1). A key term to find in the first section.

2. Turn sunlight into food for the tree. (1 point)

Finding information (RI.3.1). Finding the job of the pigment, stated directly in the text.

3. Something that gives color. (1 point)

Word meaning (RI.3.4). The text defines the word, so the child practices finding a definition in the passage.

4. Any two of: the days get shorter; the nights get cooler; the tree makes less chlorophyll. (2 points)

Finding information (RI.3.1). Collecting two facts from one short section.

5. The green color is so strong that it hides them. When the green fades, the yellow and orange show through. (2 points)

Explaining from the text. A cause-and-effect answer that must be built from two sentences in the text.

6. Anthocyanins. (1 point)

Finding information (RI.3.1). Finding a specific word in the “Red leaves” section.

7. Carrots. (1 point)

Finding information (RI.3.1). A detail tucked inside a sentence, which children must read closely to find.

8. One point for saying leaves change color in the fall, and one for a reason: the tree makes less chlorophyll so hidden yellow and orange colors show, and some leaves make red pigments. (2 points)

Summarizing (RI.3.2). Summing up a whole text in one sentence is a key reading skill.